

Field Guides / Coaching

Coaching for videographers vs production company owners

Yes, because the constraint is different. A solo videographer usually needs focus: one clear offer, one kind of client, a minimum price and one repeatable way work comes in. A production company owner usually needs structure, because the business works but only through them. Buy coaching for the constraint you have today, which a ten-line self-check will show you.

Why do videographers and production company owners need different coaching?

Videographers and production company owners need different coaching because the thing holding each one back is different, and coaching aimed at the wrong constraint adds work without moving the business.

When you are the business, effort is the growth strategy, and effort has a ceiling. There are only so many days you can sell before fatigue, mistakes or burnout show up. More clients, more gear and more late nights add pressure rather than momentum. What moves things at this point is focus: one offer, one type of client, one way work comes in.

Once there's a team, the constraint moves. Work comes in, money flows, and everything still runs through you for approval. Your team waits for you because nobody has defined what they own. You can take a week off but not a month. That's the operator ceiling: revenue stops at what one person can personally hold together, and the fix is structural.

Many owners place themselves one step further along than they are. The reliable test is what's actually in place in the business, which is what the self-check below asks about.

How to work out which coaching you need: the method, step by step

The method is a ten-line self-check against what's true in your business this month, then one question to put to any coach you're considering.

1. **Fill in the self-check.** Answer each line yes or no, based on what's in place today, not what's planned.

Copy and paste: the ten-line self-check

Foundations

1. My niche is one specific market, written down. [yes or no]
2. I have one packaged offer with a price floor. [yes or no]
3. I have a minimum project fee, and I hold it with no exceptions. [yes or no]
4. One sales activity runs every week, whether I'm busy or not. [yes or no]
5. I know which clients and projects actually make money. [yes or no]

Structure

6. My pricing is written down: day rates, project minimums, package options. [yes or no]
7. My delivery process is written down, from brief to final delivery. [yes or no]
8. At least one freelancer or team member has run a job without me overseeing it. [yes or no]
9. I'm not shooting or editing on any project. [yes or no]
10. The business could run for a month without my daily involvement. [yes or no]

2. **Find your first no.** If any of lines 1 to 5 is a no, your coaching need is foundations, whatever your revenue. If lines 1 to 5 are all yes and lines 6 to 10 are mostly no, your need is structure.
3. **Write down the question that keeps coming back.** If it's "where does the next client come from", that usually confirms foundations. If it's "why am I still on every shoot when we're this busy", that usually confirms structure. If the question and the self-check disagree, trust the self-check.
4. **Ask the coach who they're built for.** Most coaches serve one of the two needs better than the other. Ask before you join.

Copy and paste: the question to ask any coach

Most of the owners you work with: are they solo, or running a team? What does a typical member's business look like when they join, and what's the first thing you work on with them?

5. **Match the answer to your first no.** A coach whose typical member looks like you, and whose first piece of work matches your first no, is worth a closer look.

A worked example

Here are three made-up owners in round numbers, to show that the self-check, not revenue, decides the coaching.

Owner	Revenue (round)	First no	Coaching need
Solo videographer, work comes through referrals	\$120,000	Line 3: no minimum project fee	Foundations
Production company, five people, process written down	\$400,000	Line 9: still on every shoot	Structure
Owner with two freelancers, busy all year	\$350,000	Line 3: no minimum project fee	Foundations

The third owner earns nearly three times the first and needs the same kind of coaching, because the first no sits on the same line.

The mistakes that send owners to the wrong coaching

Four mistakes send owners to coaching built for a different business.

- **Buying for the business you want.** The instinct to work on hiring or scale is often right and early. Close the first no before moving on.
- **Using revenue as the test.** Revenue says you can pay. It doesn't say what's in place.
- **Systemising before the offer is clear.** Simplify first, systemise second, and never build complex systems on top of chaos.

- **Hiring before the process is on paper.** Hiring and automation make sense once you've written down what gets handed over. Until then, the person you hire has nothing to work from except you.

Who is the Elite Boardroom built for?

The Elite Boardroom is built for established production company owners who are done being the person everything routes through, with \$150,000 a year as the baseline, not the test. Past that baseline the filter is behaviour: you do the work between calls, you can be challenged, and you act within days. The Elite Boardroom is \$1,700 USD a month, flat, cancel anytime, with no application, and month one is the fit test. Solo videographers still working through lines 1 to 5 will get more from the free [Field Guides](#) for now. More on how the coaching works at [the video business coach page](#).

The rule of thumb for coaching by stage

Coach the constraint you have today: foundations until lines 1 to 5 are all yes, structure after that. Benchmark: the ten-line self-check, filled in against what's in place this month, with your first no as the starting point for any coaching conversation.

Hold yourself accountable

Which of these have you taken on or put in place recently?

- You've filled in the ten-line self-check against what's true this month.
- You know your first no.
- You've asked any coach you're considering who their typical member is.
- You've stopped working on anything above your first no until it's closed.

Your one move this week

What's the one thing you can commit to implementing this week? If you're not sure, start here.

Fill in the self-check and circle your first no. Then spend one hour on that line: write down your niche, set the minimum fee, or document the first stage of your delivery process. Take the result into any coaching conversation you have.

One thing executed every week creates 50 strategic moves a year.

Questions like these come up regularly on our weekly Elite Boardroom calls. If you'd like someone to hold you to account each week, and to learn from a group of peers who run video businesses too, [the Boardroom is for you](#).

Related tools and guides. [How to price a video project](#), [Know your numbers](#), [How to qualify a video lead before you pitch](#), [What is the S.C.A.L.E. Method?](#), [When a production company is ready for a coach](#), [Field Guides](#).



The field guides show you how the system works. The Boardroom is where I look at your business with you, give you perspective and judgement on what to do next, and hold you to it every week.

Last reviewed 8 October 2026. denlennie.com

© 2026 Den Lennie. Free to read and use in your own business. Not for republishing or resale.